ECOLOGICAL MMA SYSTEM · DRAFT, NOT BUILT

Game Gaps & Draft Constraint Sheets

2026-07-05 · quick reference for today's class · library currently 58 games

THE GAP CHECK

1. **Leg locks: zero coverage.**
   No leg entanglement, ankle lock, kneebar, or heel hook game anywhere in the 58-game library. A whole major grappling category is missing.

2. **Two ground positions have offense but no escape.**
   Mount, side control, and back all have a matched offense/escape pair. Knee-on-belly and north-south only have the offense side, no dedicated escape page for either.

3. **Transition Zone is 100% defensive.**
   Both games tagged Transition (clinch-denial, counter-wrestling) are defense-only. Nothing trains actively forcing or exploiting the striking-to-clinch-to-shot seam itself.

4. **Skill-isolation is 100% striking.**
   All 9 isolated single-skill games are striking. Wrestling and grappling have no isolation tier, a beginner meets a shot or a hip escape only inside a full combined game.

5. **Wall has no submission-offense page.**
   wall-defensive-submission exists for the escaping side, but there's no page for finishing a choke while holding wall control, the way mount-submission-hunt exists opposite mount-maintenance.

FOUR DRAFT SHEETS TO TEST TODAY

Knee-on-Belly Escape READY TODAY

Fills gap #2. Mirrors mount-escape and side-control-escape exactly.

POSITION	Bottom pinned under knee-on-belly, top's knee driving into the belly/ribs.
ROLES	Top: maintain and hunt. Bottom: escape.
CONSTRAINT	Top must keep the knee connected or re-establish it immediately. Bottom can frame, shrimp, and turn, but no explosive bench-press escape without a real frame first.
WIN / LOSE	Bottom recovers guard or half guard with a real frame between the knee and their hips or ribs, bottom wins. Top isolates an arm or advances to mount or side, top wins.
TERMINAL GOAL	Guard recovery vs. mount/submission entry.
ATTUNE TO	Bottom reads the pressure direction through the knee (the felt load) to know which way is free. Top reads the bottom's framing hand to know when to switch the knee or hunt the arm.

North-South Escape READY TODAY

Fills gap #2. Same proven pattern as above, different position.

POSITION	Bottom pinned under north-south, top's chest on bottom's chest/head, facing opposite ways.
ROLES	Top: pin and hunt kimura or choke. Bottom: turn in and recover.
CONSTRAINT	Top keeps weight forward and heavy, no floating. Bottom must get an elbow or knee inside before turning, no blind bridging.
WIN / LOSE	Bottom turns in, gets a knee or elbow inside, and recovers half guard or guard, bottom wins. Top traps an arm for a kimura entry or slides to side control, top wins.
TERMINAL GOAL	Guard recovery vs. kimura entry / side control.
ATTUNE TO	Bottom reads where the top's weight is loaded through the chest contact to find the free side to turn into. Top reads the bottom's far arm to know when the kimura trap is live.

Transition Offense READY TODAY

Fills gap #3. Owns the seam itself, distinct from pressure-to-clinch and pressure-to-takedown, which score the full chain.

POSITION	Open space, the seam between striking range and clinch or shot range.
ROLES	Offense: force the transition. Defense: deny it, same tools as clinch-denial / counter-wrestling.
CONSTRAINT	Offense wins only by landing IN the transition (a real clinch tie-up, or a hand on the leg mid-shot), not by completing the eventual takedown or strike. Must come off a genuine strike-first or feint-first setup, no cold shots.
WIN / LOSE	Offense secures the clinch or the leg, offense wins, switch. Defense keeps them out for a set duration or count, defense wins.
TERMINAL GOAL	The seam itself as a trained skill, not just its downstream result.
ATTUNE TO	Offense reads the opening their own strike or feint creates in the defender's guard/hips to time the level change. Defense reads the offense's shoulder-drop and hip-dip (how fast it grows) to know when to sprawl or deny.

Leg Entanglement, Position Only TEST CAUTIOUSLY

Starts filling gap #1, the biggest one. Deliberately narrowed: position only, no finishes, same sequencing you used for wall control and turtle before submissions were added.

POSITION	Ground, both players tangled at the legs (single-leg or 50/50-style entanglement).
ROLES	Combined, both players are simultaneously trying to win the stronger foot position over the other.
CONSTRAINT	No submissions, no cranking, no finishing attempts of any kind. Position recognition and position control only.
WIN / LOSE	Achieve the stronger foot position (e.g. outside ankle control, both your hooks in, their foot exposed and yours protected), held for a count, you win, switch. If your own foot becomes the exposed one, you lose the exchange regardless of anything else.
TERMINAL GOAL	Prove the position is understood and controllable before any submission is ever added.
ATTUNE TO	The felt rotation and pressure through the entangled legs, the same haptic channel as every other game in this system, just at the ankle instead of the wrist or collar.

> **Safety:** no submissions live at this stage. Heel hooks especially need dedicated constraint and safety design before ever going live, don't skip ahead on this one.

Drafted from a live gap-check against games.json, not yet mined from a class. Test, record, and the usual audio-mining pipeline turns whatever survives into a real page.